RESEARCH, PRODUCT & BUSINESS DEVELOPMENT DIVISION / DOCUMENT V03-A

Bank Fieldwork Instruments & Conditional Sponsor Templates

Interview guide • coded evidence forms • pricing elicitation • non-binding expression of interest

Version 1.0 | 19 October 2026 | Evidence cut-off: 19 October 2026 | Classification: Confidential - proposed research instrument

Status: Draft for management and Legal/CISO review. Not an authorised bank outreach or validated commercial result.

Use conditions — read before issuing to any bank

These are internal research templates. No bank has approved or signed them. Externally shared versions require PSS Legal/Compliance review, designation of an authorised bank contact and any necessary confidentiality agreement. Responses are research inputs, never evidence of bank commitment unless the signatory has documented authority.

A1 Bank recruitment and respondent qualification sheet

Field	Entry to be completed
Bank research code / outreach date	Bank ID: _____ Date: _____
Shareholder / non-shareholder (research stratum)	_____; do not assume access privileges
Acquiring profile and merchant types	_____; cite publicly available / bank-supplied source
Lead economic buyer / role / authority	Role: _____ Authority basis: _____
Operations / technology / finance voices	Roles interviewed: _____
Existing provider / internal solution	_____
Permission for interview and note-taking	Granted / declined / pending; documentary basis: _____
Interview status / nonresponse reason	Not contacted / scheduled / done / declined / follow-up
Researcher and independent reviewer	_____ / _____

A2 Opening statement and consent script

Thank you for considering this PSS research interview. We are evaluating possible merchant-acceptance infrastructure services and comparing them with existing bank services and external alternatives. This interview is exploratory and non-binding. No new service, pricing or regulatory permission is being promised. We will record business-level observations with a respondent code, not request sensitive customer data, and use findings only in an authorised internal assessment. You may decline any question. Are you comfortable proceeding on that basis? May we take written notes? Audio recording, if proposed, requires separate express approval.

Consent checkpoint	Response
Interview and business-level notes	Yes / No; date/time _____
Optional audio recording	Not proposed / explicitly authorised / declined
Follow-up for aggregate information	Yes / No; method _____
Bank confidentiality restrictions	_____
Bank reviewer for factual summary	Role: _____

A3 Bank discovery interview — before showing concepts

#	Theme	Neutral question
1	Institution and strategy	What merchant-acquiring or bank acceptance outcomes matter most this year, and how are those objectives measured?
2	Institution and strategy	What payment rails and acceptance channels currently serve your merchant segments? Which third parties are involved?
3	Operating baseline	Walk through the last merchant acceptance exception or reconciliation mismatch that required investigation. What happened?
4	Operating baseline	How are success, failure, timeout, reversal, duplicate and pending statuses determined and

#	Theme	Neutral question
		communicated today?
5	Operating baseline	Which teams own merchant disputes, reconciliation and complaints, and what triggers an escalation?
6	Operating baseline	What are the volumes of affected records, staff effort and direct third-party charges over a normal period?
7	Operating baseline	Which processes are manual, and what has changed in the past six months?
8	Operational evidence	Which KPI dashboards or reports would show that an improvement is real rather than assumed?
9	Existing alternative	If PSS proposed nothing new, what changes would your bank make independently or with its current providers?
10	Existing alternative	What features or outcomes already work well, and which vendor contractual limits would constrain a change?
11	Existing alternative	What has the bank tried before? Why did it succeed, fail or get deferred?
12	Commercial value	If this problem disappeared tomorrow, what would the bank save or gain, and who could validate that figure?
13	Commercial value	Which expected benefits are cash savings versus operational convenience or strategic benefits?
14	Buying authority	Who owns the budget, who signs vendor procurement, and how are technology risk and policy approvals obtained?
15	Buying authority	What is the next decision date and what evidence would make this eligible for an approved procurement process?
16	Buying authority	What are the non-negotiable security, data, vendor and SLA constraints?
17	Segmentation	Which merchant segment creates the most operational friction or incremental revenue opportunity?
18	Bank sponsor	Who else needs to verify the facts and costs discussed before a commercial evaluation can proceed?

A4 Controlled concept test — rotate order

Present the following as mutually comparable proposed service concepts; do not imply deployment readiness or scheme/regulatory approval. Randomise/rotate B, C, D and E order across interviews; present A after the narrower alternatives to avoid anchoring.

Code	Neutral concept card	Comparison prompt
B	Operate + Connect: bank-facing merchant operations, transaction-status evidence, reconciliation/exception tools and reusable authorised adapters.	Which specific bank job improves? What would you stop using?
C	PSS Pay-led: expand phone-based contactless card acceptance in suitable segments using the actual certified product scope, subject to verification.	How many relevant bank merchants and devices are eligible?
D	Partner-led: PSS supplies managed bank integration/support through a specialist third-party solution, subject to vendor contracting.	What vendor assurance and exit controls would be required?
E	Business as usual: retain/improve existing bank and PSS solutions; no incremental shared platform.	What would this alternative cost and deliver?
A	Broader multi-module Acceptance 360: combine acceptance, connectivity, merchant operations and later value-added services.	What extra commercial value offsets the larger scope?

After each concept	Response fields
Top two benefits / biggest objection	_____
Rank 1–5 / why	_____
Which current alternative would it replace?	_____
Prerequisites / no-go conditions	_____
Actual follow-up requested / refused	_____

A5 Willingness-to-pay interview — actual numbers only

Ask price questions in this order. Write “not disclosed” rather than inventing figures. Finance must approve any later anchor ranges based on validated costs and bank comparator evidence; quote amounts to no respondent as an existing tariff.

1. What does your bank currently spend annually on the exact workflows, including staff hours, third-party invoices and change support? Can the owner substantiate the estimate?
2. What is the maximum justified annual spend for a solution that achieves your stated outcome, before viewing a proposed fee?
3. Would your bank prefer implementation fee + monthly minimum, a merchant-based fee, a transaction-based fee or a documented hybrid, and why?

4. Under which scenario would you reject the offer even if it solved the pain? What alternatives do you have?
5. For any later Finance-approved price card, state buy/consider/reject at each price and a reason; rotate order across bank participants.
6. Who can approve a priced statement of work? Is the amount inside approved budget or dependent on a future budget cycle?
7. What minimum volumes, service conditions, liability protections, reporting and termination provisions must be included?
8. Would an authorised representative review a non-binding conditional term sheet specifying scope and indicative price architecture?

Bank pricing evidence (ETB)	Response	Evidence / confidence
Current attributable annual operating spend	_____	Reported / documents seen / not supplied
Maximum self-reported annual spend	_____	Unprompted / prompted; buyer role
Implementation fee willingness	_____	Conditional on scope and milestone
Monthly bank minimum willingness	_____	Budget source and cap
Per active merchant / transaction fee	_____	Billable event and exclusions
Bank quantified annual benefit	_____	Cash/non-cash; source
Procurement authority and window	_____	Name held separately
Price card used and version	_____	Approved by CFO? Yes / No

A6 Independent summary and contradiction note

Finding / issue	Completed response
Three strongest bank-specific facts	1) _____ 2) _____ 3) _____
Strongest contradictory evidence	_____
What cannot be independently corroborated	_____
Buyer level L0–L5 with evidence link	_____
Preferred option and reason	_____
Price evidence type (not just amount)	_____
Required follow-up, owner, deadline	_____
Bank factual-summary confirmation	Received / pending / declined
Second reviewer and dissent	_____

B1 Non-binding bank expression-of-interest template

FORM OF DISCUSSION LETTER — LEGAL REVIEW REQUIRED. THIS DRAFT IS NOT AN OFFER, PROCUREMENT AWARD, PURCHASE ORDER, REGULATORY APPROVAL OR COMMITMENT TO ENTER A CONTRACT.

From: [Authorised bank institution and representative]
To: Premier Switch Solutions S.C. [Correct legal entity to be verified]
Date: [date]
Reference: Exploratory evaluation of a proposed merchant-acceptance infrastructure service

We confirm interest in assessing the business case for [specific proposed service/function], solely for discussion and subject to our internal governance, procurement, risk, technical, regulatory and legal requirements. The proposed scope, merchant segment, integration requirements, pricing structure and service levels remain subject to separate evaluation and definitive agreement.

The bank may, subject to separate written authorisation, nominate operational, technology and commercial personnel to validate the use case and review a proposed non-binding outline. No personal/customer information, bank records, production access or confidential datasets are authorised by this letter. Nothing in this letter establishes exclusivity, data-sharing rights, financial commitment, procurement selection, approval to deploy, or agency/partnership.

Either party may discontinue discussions without penalty. Any external disclosure of this exploratory engagement requires both parties' express written permission. This draft is subject to Legal review and may be amended to reflect applicable law and bank policy.

Bank commercial/economic sponsor	Authorised signature / date
Name and official title: _____	Signature: _____

Bank commercial/economic sponsor	Authorised signature / date
Bank approval / signing authority checked by: _____	Date: _____

B2 Indicative non-binding commercial term sheet — discussion only

Commercial term	Working field (not a commitment)
Bank / service provider legal names	_____
Purpose / pain and target outcome	_____
Proposed service modules B/C/D/A	_____
Merchant segment / geography / estimate basis	_____
Responsibility for acquiring, KYC, settlement and scheme rules	To be determined by original licences, bank and network agreements
Service boundaries and exclusions	_____
Integration and bank input conditions	_____
Implementation fee (ETB) and basis	Blank pending bank/CFO-validated inputs
Fixed monthly minimum and usage charges	Blank pending bank/CFO-validated inputs
SLA measures and remedies	_____
Bank operational benefit and independent validation	_____
Data location, access, confidentiality and retention	Subject to formal DSA / Legal / CISO approval
Expected procurement path and timing	_____
Dispute and liability allocation	To be negotiated and legally approved
No exclusivity / no production authorisation	Expressly not granted
Binding / non-binding status	NON-BINDING in all respects until definitive contract

B3 Follow-up information request (only where authorised)

Request code	Permitted evidence requested	Handling rule
BANK-01	Aggregate monthly active merchants and acceptance channel mix	No personal/card or account data
BANK-02	Aggregated transactions by status, reversal and exception class	Bank-generated non-identifying summary
BANK-03	Merchant support ticket volumes and average resolution times	Redacted categories, no identifiers
BANK-04	Staff time spent per workflow and unit labour cost estimate	Bank-approved finance aggregate
BANK-05	External fee schedule for comparable services / supplier cost range	Only if bank policy permits; segregate competitors
BANK-06	Current bank service-level and audit reporting requirements	Bank-authorised sanitized schedules
BANK-07	Decision memo and procurement process outline	No confidential approvals without express permission
BANK-08	Technology integration pattern, support owner and constraints	High-level architecture only until NDA/approval

B4 Bank-level sign-off and interview quality checklist

Control	Status / document link
Written permission to approach bank	Pending / verified _____
Consent / confidentiality script applied	Pending / verified _____
Discovery completed before concept pitch	Pending / verified _____
Bank economic buyer positively identified	Pending / verified _____
Contradictory findings recorded	Pending / verified _____
Pricing not represented as existing PSS tariff	Pending / verified _____
Any cost/volume record independently reviewed	Pending / verified _____
No unauthorised personal / payment data collected	Pending / verified _____
Term-sheet legal status verified	Pending / verified _____
Bank is counted only once in analysis	Pending / verified _____

Source basis: V03 Protocol v1; CGAP acquiring-model guidance; S02/S03 internal drafts. All blank fields are intentionally unfilled. No interview, legal opinion or bank sign-off is implied.